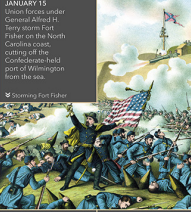


TIMELINE 1865

The Thirteenth Amendment ■ **Lincoln's second term as president** ■ Battle of Bentonville ■ **Siege of Petersburg** ■ Fall of Richmond ■ **Surrender at Appomattox Court House** ■ Assassination of Lincoln ■ **Last battle at Palmito Ranch**

“Thank God I have lived to see this. It seems to me that I have been **dreaming a horrid dream** for four years, and **now the nightmare is gone.**”

PRESIDENT ABRAHAM LINCOLN ON HEARING THAT THE CONFEDERATE CAPITAL OF RICHMOND HAD FINALLY FALLEN, APRIL 3, 1865

JANUARY	FEBRUARY	MARCH	APRIL	MAY	JUNE
JANUARY 15 Union troops under General Alfred H. Fisher arrive at the North Carolina coast, cutting off the Confederate-held port of Wilmington from the sea. ▼ Sighting Fort Fisher 	FEBRUARY 3 President Lincoln and Secretary of War Edwin M. Stanton meet Confederate commissioners aboard the steamboat Queen for abortive peace talks. 	FEBRUARY 17 Sherman's troops take Columbia, capital of South Carolina. The night, much of the city goes up in flames in North Carolina. Confederate forces evacuate the port of Charleston. MARCH 2 Lincoln begins his second term as U.S. president. MARCH 7 At the second Battle of Kinston, Confederate forces under General Bragg fail to halt the progress of Union troops advancing from Wilmington to join Sherman. MARCH 13 In a last-ditch attempt to courtier, Harper's shortages, the Confederate Congress authorizes the conscription of Black troops. MARCH 22 A Union force under General John M. Schofield occupies Wilmington, North Carolina. FEBRUARY 22 The real forces arrived outside Petersburg fight an inconclusive engagement at Hatcher's Run to the south of the city. FEBRUARY 23 At Lee's residence, General Joseph E. Johnston takes command of the Confederate forces facing Sherman's Union army in the Carolinas. FEBRUARY 27 General Joseph E. Johnston's Army of the Shenandoah moves out of winter quarters, under instruction from Union commander in chief Ulysses S. Grant to head east.	MARCH 22 A Union cavalry force under General James H. Wilson launches a raid southward through Alabama, intended to destroy Confederate resistance in the state. ▼ Lincoln's gold mounted, engraved Henry rifle MARCH 23 Sherman's Union army, driving northward through North Carolina, succeeds in reestablishing at Goldsboro with Schofield's force, marching inland from Wilmington to join Sherman. MARCH 25 A Confederate assault on Fort Steadman in the Union lines outside Petersburg initially succeeds, but is soon beaten back at a heavy cost to them. MARCH 28 Grant and Sherman meet with President Lincoln and Admiral David D. Porter on the River Queen to discuss Union strategy for ending the war. MARCH 29 General Grant launches the final operation of the Petersburg siege, designed to prevent a Confederate breakout to the southwest of the city. APRIL 1 Union forces break through the right wing of the Confederate lines outside Petersburg at Fort Forks, threatening Lee's last supply line and making his position vulnerable. APRIL 2 In face of a Union assault, Confederate forces withdraw from Petersburg after an eight-month siege in Alabama. James H. Wilson's Union cavalry breaks through Confederate lines to capture Selma. APRIL 2 The first Union troops arrive in Richmond, the day after the Confederate government has evacuated the city. APRIL 6 Union forces pursuing Lee's retreating army cut off almost a quarter of the Confederate force at Sawyer's Creek, capturing some 7,500 men. APRIL 7 Confederate commander-in-chief Ulysses S. Grant sends a note to Lee inviting Lee to surrender, asking for details of the terms. APRIL 14 President Lincoln is shot by the actor and Confederate sympathizer John Wilkes Booth. APRIL 26 At Fort Carolina, Union general William T. Sherman accepts the surrender of General Joseph E. Johnston.	APRIL 9 General Grant and Lee meet at the village of Appomattox Court House in south-central Virginia. Lee accepts the terms of surrender offered by the Union commander, bringing the war in Virginia to an end. ▼ Lincoln's funeral procession MAY 4 Abraham Lincoln's body is laid to rest in Oak Ridge Cemetery, outside his hometown of Springfield, Illinois. MAY 8 General Richard Taylor, the Confederate commander in Alabama, agrees to terms of surrender, ending the war in the south. MAY 10 The fugitive Confederate president, Jefferson Davis, is captured by Union troops in Georgia. MAY 12-13 The final battle of the Civil War is fought at Palmito Ranch on the Rio Grande in Texas. Technically, it ends in a Union retreat. MAY 23 The Army of the Potomac parades through Washington, D.C. in a grand victory celebration. Sherman's Army of Georgia repeats the performance on the following day. ▼ Victory parade JUNE 2 Confederate cruiser Shenandoah escapes operations against Union shipping in the Bering Sea. JUNE 10 US Major general Gordon Granger arrives in Galveston, Texas, and enforces the Emancipation Proclamation. JUNE 23 David Wills, the Confederate commander of Kirby Smith's cavalry division, finally agrees to a ceasefire. ▼ David Wills	